PERNOD RICARD INDIA'S WATER STEWARDSHIP

Local Solutions for Lasting Change

As the world marks World Water Week, the spotlight falls once again on one of the most pressing challenges of our times: managing water sustainably. In India, where agriculture consumes nearly 80% of freshwater and erratic rainfall continues to strain groundwater reserves, the urgency could not be clearer. Communities and companies alike must take responsibility for safeguarding this vital resource.

One company that has made water a cornerstone of its sustainability agenda is Pernod Ricard India (PRI). Through its global "Good Times from a Good Place" framework, the company has embedded water stewardship into its flagship Water, Agriculture, Livelihoods (WAL) program. Designed to deliver impact at the grassroots level, the program reaches over 22,000 farmers annually, helping strengthen resilience in some of India's most water-stressed regions.

"At Pernod Ricard India, we adopt a bottom-up approach to collaborate with communities to design solutions that are inclusive, adaptable, and sustainable over time," says Gagandeep Sethi, Senior Vice President, Integrated Operations and S&R (Sustainability & Responsibility), Pernod Ricard India. "This ensures that strategies are responsive to local needs and built for long-term success."

From Scarcity to Sustainability

Since 2019, Pernod Ricard India has constructed 2,355 groundwater recharge structures, creating a recharge potential of 4,484 million litres of groundwater - replenishing more than 2.6 times the groundwater used in its operations. These interventions have been particularly critical in drought-prone regions and help safeguard livelihoods from climate-related disruptions.

In FY24-25 alone, the company's water interventions impacted more than 18,000 community members across 28 villages in 8 states, generating over 630 million litres of water potential.

Woman farmer in Behror displaying crop yield: best practices (left) vs. traditional farming (right).





Farmer working in the field

Water, Agriculture, Livelihood: The WAL Model

The major focus of PRI's CSR flagship programme, WAL (Water, Agriculture, Livelihoods) is safeguarding year-round access to water to for communities, promoting micro-irrigation for improved production, drought resilience, resource optimization and creating local value chains.

The impact is visible: agricultural yield has risen by 15-20%, while input costs have dropped by 18-22%. And the farmers, once reliant on erratic rainfall, are today investing in better seeds and diversifying crops—signs of a stronger rural economy.

Darshan Singh, a farmer beneficiary from Jhawansa Village, Dera Bassi, shared how he benefited from Pernod Ricard India Foundation's Krishi Kranti program by adopting sprinkler irrigation, which has helped save a significant amount of water. "Earlier I used to grow only two crops like pumpkin and brinjal and now I grow variety of crops, and I am saving water as well as my time."

Innovation in Action

What sets Pernod Ricard India's water initiatives apart is the use of digital innovation alongside traditional methods. The company partners with mission based NGOS and has set up Community Resource Centres equipped with IoT based soil water sensors and AI-driven tools to track usage patterns, monitor groundwater levels and measure agricultural productivity.

"Digitization allows us to bring precision and accountability into water stewardship," Sethi explains. "With IoT-enabled monitoring and data-driven insights, communities can see in real time how conservation efforts translate into tangible outcomes."

Region-Specific Interventions

India's water challenges vary from state to state. Recognizing this, Pernod Ricard follows a region-specific water stewardship strategy, tailoring interventions to address local ecological conditions. For example, watershed projects in Maharashtra address water scarcity, while flood management efforts in Assam build resilience against excess water. This ensures that every initiative delivers impact where it matters most.

Looking Ahead

Pernod Ricard has already achieved a 19% reduction in water consumption intensity across its operations since FY2018 and has set a target of reaching 20% by FY2030. To validate its efforts,

Water User Committee members standing proudly by the Umrale Khurd pond, Nashik.



the company also relies on third-party assessments and scientific monitoring to ensure transparency and measure long-term impact, including improvements in biodiversity, soil quality, and community water access. Recently, three of its sites in Nashik, Dera Bassi, and Behror were awarded Gold-level certificates by the Alliance for Water Stewardship, reflecting a remarkable contribution by its sustainability, CSR, and plant teams in water conservation.

As India steps up to confront one of the world's most pressing environmental challenges, examples like these underline a simple truth: every litre of water saved, replenished, or managed responsibly has the power to transform lives.

And for Pernod Ricard India, that ripple effect is just beginning.